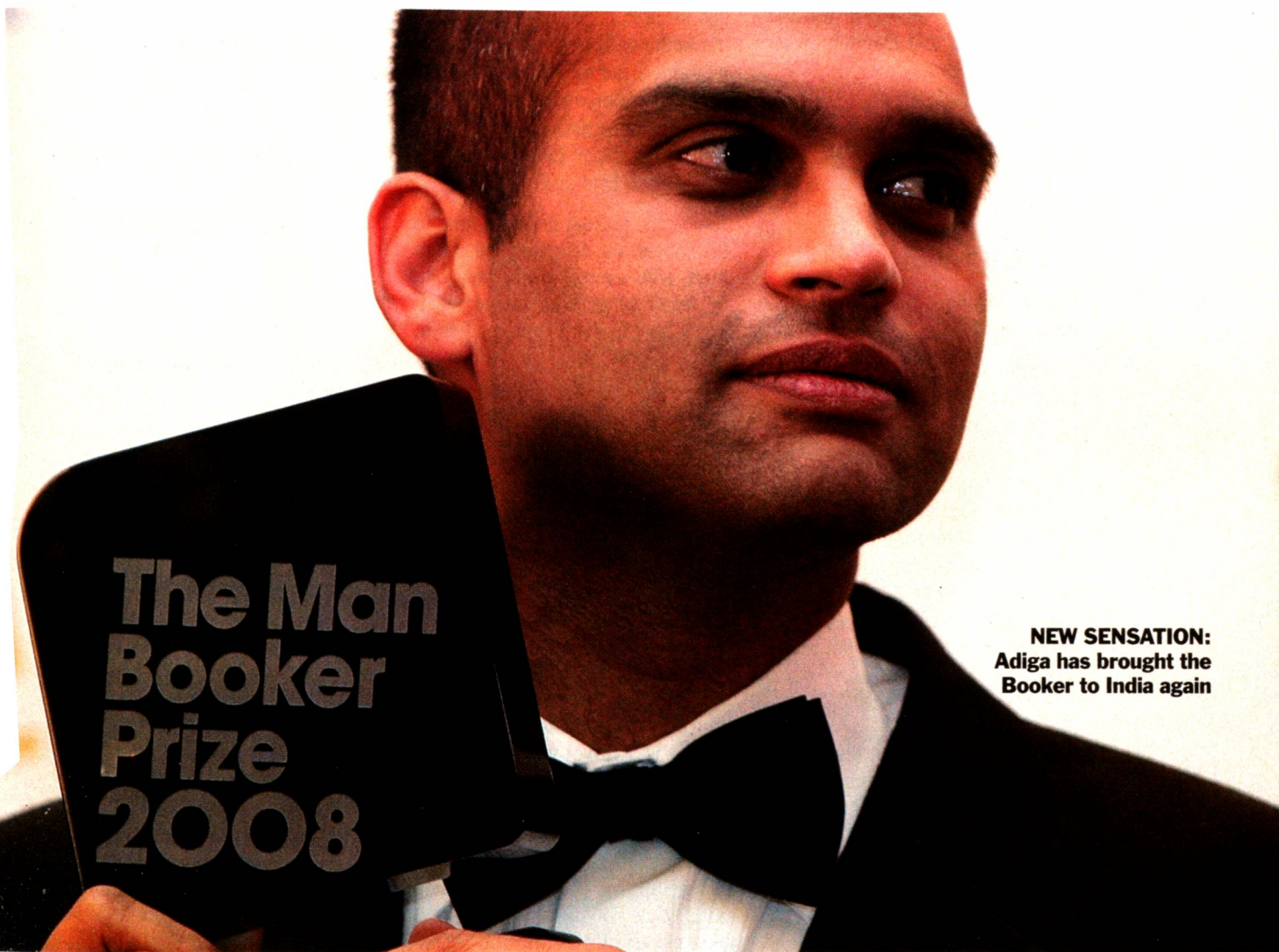


ALONE IN DUSKLAND



NEW SENSATION:
Adiga has brought the
Booker to India again

Aravind Adiga, the winner of this year's Man Booker Prize, is a first novelist who has taken an exhilarating ride through the darkest alleys of modern India

■ **By S. Prasannarajan**

In retrospect, there was perhaps unintended magnanimity in the exit of Salman Rushdie from the Booker list, in spite of some silly remarks from certain judges. It was as if the master was making the way for a brand new talent who exudes the same subversive exuberance that marked the arrival of *Midnight's Children*, voted recently as the best of Booker, more than 25 years ago. This year's winner of the Man

Booker Prize, Aravind Adiga's first novel, *The White Tiger* (published in India by HarperCollins and first featured in these pages), too, is born out of an India of whirling paradoxes, an India where the protagonist, a chauffeur-turned-killer-turned-philosophising entrepreneur, can tell the Chinese premier a few things about power and struggle from the unique perspective of a

survivor. Adiga, a former *Time* reporter in Delhi and now a contributor to the magazine, tells the story of an India where globalisation has not obliterated the reality of Bihar as the back story of Bangalore. (*The White Tiger* should be mandatory reading for Thomas Friedman.) As he writes elsewhere in the novel, "India is two countries in one: an India of Light, and an

